

Metro Atlanta Wind-Driven Rain: How to Protect Your Home from Insurance Exclusions

On June 1, 2026, *Insurance Journal* reported that thousands of property owners in the Southeast discovered catastrophic interior water damage from wind-driven rain was excluded from both their insurance policies and manufacturer warranties following recent hurricanes. This gap in coverage leaves Metro Atlanta homeowners facing unexpected financial losses when water infiltrates through sliding glass door tracks and other vulnerable exterior points. The report highlights that consumers deserve clear disclosure about these risks before the next storm strikes, not after damage occurs.

The short answer: Standard policies and warranties often exclude water damage caused by wind-driven rain entering through sliding door tracks, leaving homeowners responsible for repairs.

Who this affects: Condominium and multifamily owners in Metro Atlanta areas with aging sliding glass installations, particularly in Fulton, Gwinnett, and Cobb counties. **What to do:** Schedule a professional exterior inspection to identify vulnerable entry points and document current conditions before severe weather events. **Timeline:** Immediate action is required; do not wait for the next storm season to verify your coverage and structural integrity.

Contact Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors for a free inspection.

What Specific Damage Does Wind-Driven Rain Cause in Metro Atlanta Homes?

Wind-driven rain primarily causes catastrophic interior water damage by forcing water through the tracks of sliding glass doors and compromised roofing systems. Unlike standard rainfall, high-pressure wind drives water upward and sideways, bypassing standard flashing and seals that normally protect the home envelope. In Metro Atlanta, this issue is exacerbated by the region's mix of older construction and modern high-density housing where seal failures are common. *Insurance Journal* noted that following Hurricanes Helene and Milton, this specific type of intrusion was the main contributor to interior property losses for thousands of owners (Source: [insurancejournal.com](https://www.insurancejournal.com), June 2026).

Which Metro Atlanta Neighborhoods Are Most Vulnerable to Water Intrusion?

Condominium and multifamily complexes in high-density areas like Sandy Springs, Dunwoody, and Marietta face the highest risk due to the prevalence of sliding glass door installations. These locations often feature 1980s and 1990s builds where original seals have degraded, creating perfect channels for wind-driven rain to enter. In Gwinnett County, townhomes with shared wall structures may experience compounded damage if water penetrates one unit and spreads through common attic spaces. The vulnerability is not just about the storm's strength but the specific housing stock; approximately 80-85% of claims received by a leading Florida brokerage after recent storms were tied to this single issue (Source: [insurancejournal.com](https://www.insurancejournal.com), June 2026). Homeowners in Decatur and Brookhaven should also evaluate their properties, as the terrain and housing age in these areas can accelerate wear on exterior seals.

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How Do Insurance Exclusions Impact Roof and Exterior Claims?

Insurance exclusions for wind-driven rain mean that even if you have a comprehensive policy, damage caused by water entering through specific points like door tracks may not be covered. This exclusion creates a significant gap where the homeowner bears the full cost of remediation, despite having paid premiums for property protection. The *Insurance Journal* report emphasizes that when homeowners only discover these exclusions after catastrophic damage, it undermines trust and leads to severe financial strain (Source: [insurancejournal.com](https://www.insurancejournal.com), June 2026). For Metro Atlanta residents, this means a claim denial could occur even if the roof itself appears intact, because the water entry point is classified differently than direct roof failure.

Comparison of Vulnerability by Housing Type and Location

Location & Housing Type	Construction Era	Primary Vulnerability	Potential Claim Outcome
Sandy Springs Condos	1980s-1990s	Degraded sliding door track seals	High risk of exclusion; interior damage likely uncovered
Marietta Townhomes	1990s-2000s	Roof-to-wall joint flashing failures	Moderate risk; depends on specific policy wind clauses
Gwinnett Multifamily	2000s-2010s	Common attic water spread from single unit	Complex claims; potential for partial denial based on entry point
Fulton Single-Family	1970s-1980s	Aging roof shingles and vent boots	Standard coverage likely, but wind-driven rain exclusions may apply

Cobb Ranch Styles	1960s-1970s	Low-slope roof drainage issues	High risk of water pooling and wind-driven intrusion
DeKalb Duplexes	1990s-2000s	Shared wall water infiltration	Disputed claims; often requires proof of direct wind entry

How Can Homeowners Bridge the Gap Between Policy Exclusions and Roof Condition?

The most effective way to protect your financial interest is to proactively address the physical vulnerabilities that trigger these exclusions, such as failed flashing, aging shingles, and compromised door seals. Insurance companies often deny claims based on "maintenance issues" or specific entry points; therefore, a well-maintained roof and exterior system are your first line of defense against denial. If your sliding glass door tracks or roof flashing are deteriorated, water will find a path inside regardless of the policy language. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors recommends a thorough inspection to identify these weak points-replacing worn flashing and sealing door tracks can prevent the very damage that policies exclude. By addressing deferred maintenance now, you reduce the likelihood of a claim being categorized under an exclusion clause later.

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What Documentation Is Required to Support a Wind Damage Claim?

To support a claim, homeowners must provide clear evidence that the damage was caused by a covered peril and not by an excluded mechanism like wind-driven rain through unsealed tracks. This requires detailed photos of the exterior before and after the event, focusing on the condition of sliding door tracks, roof flashing, and sealant integrity. Without proof that the entry point was a direct result of a covered wind event rather than pre-existing wear, insurers may invoke the exclusions highlighted in recent industry reports. FEMA has identified water intrusion through sliding door tracks as a major source of hurricane damage, making it critical to document these specific areas meticulously (Source: [insurancejournal.com](https://www.insurancejournal.com), June 2026).

FAQ

Does my homeowner's insurance cover water damage from sliding glass doors in Atlanta?

Most standard policies in Atlanta exclude damage caused by wind-driven rain entering through sliding glass door tracks, classifying it as a maintenance or specific exclusion issue rather than a

covered storm peril. You must review your specific policy declarations to confirm if "wind-driven rain" is listed as an exclusion. If your door seals were worn prior to the storm, the claim is likely to be denied.

Should I file an insurance claim before or after repairing my roof in Gwinnett County?

You should always file the claim and have an adjuster inspect the damage before authorizing permanent repairs in Gwinnett County. However, you must take immediate temporary measures to prevent further water intrusion, such as tarping the roof or sealing tracks, to avoid "failure to mitigate" denials. Document all temporary repairs with photos and receipts for the adjuster.

How does the age of my home in Cobb County affect my wind damage coverage?

In Cobb County, older homes (pre-1990) often have outdated flashing and sealant technologies that are more susceptible to wind-driven rain, which can lead to claim denials if the damage is attributed to lack of maintenance. Insurers may argue that the failure of aged materials is a maintenance issue rather than storm damage. Regular inspections and updates to flashing and seals are crucial for older housing stock to maintain coverage eligibility.

What specific documents do I need to prove wind-driven rain damage for my claim?

You need dated photographs of the exterior damage, specifically showing the condition of sliding door tracks and roof flashing immediately after the storm. Include a professional inspection report from a licensed contractor like Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors that details the failure points. Also, gather any prior maintenance records to prove the seals were not neglected before the event.

Are condominiums in Fulton County more likely to have wind-driven rain exclusions?

Yes, condominiums in Fulton County are highly susceptible because policies often exclude water entry through common elements like sliding door tracks, which are frequent failure points in multi-family builds. The density of these units means water can travel between units, complicating liability. Individual unit owners must verify if their HO6 policy covers interior water damage from these specific external failures.

Can I claim manufacturer warranty coverage if my sliding door leaks during a storm?

No, manufacturer warranties typically exclude damage caused by wind-driven rain, as they cover product defects rather than performance under extreme weather conditions. As reported, thousands of owners found their warranties did not cover water infiltration through tracks during hurricanes. You must rely on your property insurance or personal funds for these repairs.

What steps should I take if my claim is denied due to a wind-driven rain exclusion?

If denied, request a detailed written explanation of the exclusion clause used and compare it against your policy declarations. Gather independent evidence from a licensed roofing contractor proving the damage was due to the storm's force rather than pre-existing neglect. You may need to appeal the decision with this new evidence or consult a professional to negotiate the scope of the loss.

How often should I inspect my roof and exterior seals in Metro Atlanta to prevent exclusions?

You should inspect your roof and exterior seals at least once a year, ideally before the peak storm months, to ensure all flashing and door tracks are sealed and intact. In Metro Atlanta, the combination of heat and humidity accelerates the degradation of sealants, making annual checks vital. Proactive maintenance is the only way to prevent insurers from classifying storm damage as a maintenance failure.

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